

European Summit of Associations of Local and Regional Authorities

DRAFT PROGRAMME

13 OCTOBER 2026 · BRUSSELS

ABOUT THE SUMMIT

Associations of Local and Regional Authorities Shaping the Global Agenda

The Summit brings together associations of local and regional authorities from Türkiye and across Europe in Brussels to articulate their distinctive added value. The meeting will address the structural barriers to municipalities' participation in climate governance and decision-making, together with the financing dimension of local implementation; the discussions will feed directly into the Joint Position Paper of Associations of Local and Regional Authorities currently being prepared by UMT.

THE CORE QUESTION

“Which functions that local governments struggle to perform alone can associations of local and regional authorities deliver jointly and effectively?”

PURPOSE, SETTING AND OUTCOME

- **Purpose:** To demonstrate, through concrete examples, how associations of local and regional authorities strengthen participation in climate governance, coordination across levels of government and implementation capacity, alongside their role in facilitating access to finance and technical assistance.
- **Setting:** Opening remarks followed by a scene-setting presentation on the COP31 context and a two-part combined thematic session with the same group of participants.
- **Outcome:** To carry participants' views and feedback on the draft position paper into the COP31 and Türkiye Working Group processes.

Context - COP31 and the Türkiye Working Group

The shared problems, proposed solutions and priority messages recorded at the Summit will be carried into the COP31 process and the Türkiye Working Group meeting.

THE PROGRAMME AT A GLANCE

TIME	SESSION	DURATION
14:00–14:30	Registration & Welcome Coffee	30 min
14:30–14:50	Opening Remarks	20 min
14:50–15:10	Setting the Scene: The Global Agenda on the Road to COP31	20 min
15:10–15:50	Combined Thematic Session – Part I: Climate Governance and Implementation Capacity: The Financing Dimension	40 min
15:50–16:00	Coffee Break	10 min

16:00–16:40	Combined Thematic Session – Part II: Bringing the Local Voice into COP31 Decision-Making	40 min
16:40–17:00	Feedback on the Position Paper and COP31 Messages	20 min
17:00–17:10	Closing, Drafting Process and Next Steps	10 min
17:10–18:10	Networking & Cocktail Reception	60 min

DETAILED PROGRAMME

14:00–14:30 | Registration & Welcome Coffee

Welcome, registration and coffee for participants.

14:30–14:50 | Opening Remarks

Short opening remarks by UMT and a European-level association of local and regional authorities. The Summit’s core question, expected outcomes and working setting are presented.

14:50–15:10 | Setting the Scene: The Global Agenda on the Road to COP31

The COP31 context, the main orientation of the Joint Position Paper of Associations of Local and Regional Authorities, and the core question for the day are presented.

15:10–16:40 | Combined Thematic Session

All participants remain in the same room. The 80 minutes of substantive discussion are organised in two parts, with a 10-minute coffee break between them.

Part I — Climate Governance and Implementation Capacity: The Financing Dimension

How associations of local and regional authorities can strengthen municipalities’ participation in the design and delivery of climate policy, coordination across levels of government and accountability; and, within this framework, aggregate financing and technical assistance needs and facilitate access to relevant resources.

- **Guiding question:** “How can associations of local and regional authorities strengthen effective and inclusive climate governance while facilitating access to the finance and technical assistance needed for local implementation?”

Part II — Bringing the Local Voice into COP31 Decision-Making

How associations of local and regional authorities can strengthen consultation, representation, data sharing and coordination across local, regional, national and European levels to bring local priorities into COP31 and other international decision-making processes.

- **Guiding question:** “How can associations of local and regional authorities carry cities’ shared needs and demands into COP31 and other international decision-making processes more effectively?”

16:40–17:00 | Feedback on the Position Paper and COP31 Messages

The main orientation of the Joint Position Paper being prepared by UMT and the messages envisaged for COP31 are presented. Participants identify gaps and priorities and suggest ways to strengthen the text.

17:00–17:10 | Closing, Drafting Process and Next Steps

UMT explains how contributions will be synthesised, how the draft will be shared with participants and how follow-up will be organised.

17:10–18:10 | Networking & Cocktail Reception

A one-hour opportunity for participating institutions to connect, explore possible collaborations and plan follow-up meetings.

SUMMIT OUTCOME

The views expressed at the Summit and feedback on the position paper will be synthesised by UMT; the priority messages will be carried into the COP31 process and the Türkiye Working Group meeting.

NEXT STEPS

1. Synthesis of Summit Findings

Thematic session notes and feedback on the position paper are compiled by UMT.

2. Draft Joint Position Paper

The paper is updated and shared with participating associations of local and regional authorities for their views.

3. COP31 and the Türkiye Working Group

The priority messages set out in the paper are carried into the relevant international and regional processes.

● **Date:** 13 October 2026

● **Venue:** Square de Meeûs 1, 1000 Brussels